

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 726 February 2010 PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Robert Hawes, Steve Dowall and Reece Geursen on the summit of Mt Aspiring

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 1 March 2010

Short talks

Jesse Bailey & Scott Taylor – Mt Cook via Zurbriggens Ridge

Nina Sawicki – High Alpine Skills Course

Hinrich Schaefer – Research in McMurdo Sound and the Dry Valleys, Antarctica



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Banff Mountain Film Festival 2010

**Wellington screenings: Tuesday 27 & Thursday 29 April
Paramount Cinema, 25 Courtney Place, at 6:30 pm**

Preview: www.banffcentre.ca/MountainCulture/Tour/



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Mt Aspiring – January 2010

After Xmas, Robert Hawes, Steve Dowall and Reece Geursen spent 8 days in Mt Aspiring National Park, aiming to climb Mt Aspiring. The plan was to spend two days walking in via French Ridge, and six days in Colin Todd hut, hanging out for a weather window. Our main goal was an attempt on the Ramp with the Northwest Ridge as back-up if snow conditions prevented an attempt on the Ramp.

The weather forecast for the week wasn't looking fantastic but there were a couple of potential windows. So we set off in the rain to the grunt up to French Ridge hut for the night. The next day it was up to the quarter deck, which was in pretty good condition, and over the Bonar to Colin Todd hut. On the way we met a couple of parties returning from attempts on the Pope's Nose, who had been turned back by thick cloud on the peak.

We had suspicions that Colin Todd was going to be pretty full and picked up the pace a little when we heard a helicopter. Shortly after that we saw a party heading for the hut but luckily we were able to secure one bunk in the hut giving the other two a bit more room in the tent. There were a few other tents that night, all attempting to shelter from the gale winds. We ended up moving our tent to try and prevent getting blown away, but still spent a noisy night worrying that the tent wouldn't survive.

The next morning the tent was still in one piece, but it was still blowing pretty hard and we made the call that it was too windy to attempt the Ramp. Instead we set off to climb Rolling Pin and traverse across its top. Other parties weren't so deterred by the wind and about three parties got to the top that day, one pair in the blistering time of 6 hours!



On Rolling Pin looking back at Aspiring in the background

The success of these parties gave us some extra motivation to at least head out the next day. The weather forecast was for more wind, a freezing level over 3000m, and deteriorating in the afternoon but we were determined to get out and see what it was like. So after a 1:15am wake-up to give us time to hide the tent from Keas, we were off. The snow conditions weren't great because of the high freezing level, and getting across the shrund at the bottom of the Ramp was a little dicey. But we were soon on the Ramp and making our way up.

We were the first party on the Ramp and could see a group of lights following us below. The lights soon disappeared though, and it wasn't until we got back to the hut that we found out that they had returned after a narrow miss with some falling rocks.

Plugging our way up the Ramp was slow going with soft snow conditions so it was a relief to get to the ridge proper. Once past the Ramp however, we were more exposed to the wind and there were a few times when we had to stop to hold on until some of the stronger gusts had passed. But it wasn't too long before we summited to great views.



On the summit of Aspiring

The approaching front could be seen off to the south west so we didn't hang about on the summit long. We decided to descend via the same route and as we climbed lower, the cloud level lowered with us, staying slightly above us the whole way. The descent was going well until some falling ice made us pick up the pace a bit. Luckily we were able to find some sheltered spots and it wasn't too long before we were through the worst of it and back on the glacier heading for the hut and some long overdue lunch.

The following day was a rest day and happily coincided with a rubbish weather forecast. No other parties attempted Aspiring that day and after the morning cloud it turned into a

bit of a scorcher. We could see the cloud covering the valley and apparently Wanaka residents had their fires going while we sweated above the cloud.

With an okay forecast for the following day we decided to have another attempt, this time up the full NW ridge. Another early start meant that we were the first ones to leave the hut and Robert did a great job finding the route up through the gendarmes and to the top of the main buttress. It was then back to the top section, which had a lot more rock exposed after the heat of the previous day and another night with the freezing level over 3000m.

After lingering on the top for a bit of a breather and to soak up the view it was back to the top of the Ramp for some lunch, followed by the job of retracing our steps back down the ridge. Rob's markers helped a lot and we were soon back at the hut. It was a nice feeling to know that the people who had last summited before us were also us! The next day we trekked over to Mt French and climbed it via the breakaway ridge - an easy day.

By now we'd all managed to get hut bunks, and our last night in Colin Todd was much improved by the leftovers from a departing guided party. We feasted on steak (apart from vegetarian Robert) and fresh home-grown greens for our last evening meal, giving us energy for the next day's long, hot slog heading down Bevan col and back to the world.

Reece Geursen



Walk in to French Ridge hut
in the background



Heading back down the NW Ridge

It never rains in sunny Southern Westland

Section members Richard Davies, Graham Bussell and Quentin Duthie joined up with Eric Duggan from the CNI section, and free-lancer Ben Clendon, and took advantage of a weeks worth of hot fine weather on the coast. Up the Karangarua, over Howitt and Gladiator, a night at Harpers Rock biv then down the Landsborough to Toetoe flat and out via the Solution Range and the Otoko. Great trip. Raro, Miso and sun-screen were the highest value currency.



On the Solution Range, Mt Hooker beyond

2010 National Bouldering Series – Baring Head Rock Hop



The 2010 Baring Head Rock Hop was a great day out, with perfect weather – sunny and calm, conditions which are almost unheard of at Baring Head. The results were as follows:

EXPERT MALE			EXPERT FEMALE		
PLACING	NAME	SCORE	PLACING	NAME	SCORE
1st =	Pete Allison	631	1st =	Amie Jones	191
1st =	Josh Kerr	631	1st =	Helen Sinclair	191
3rd	Tyler Fleury	610	3rd	Judy Cheng	23

JUNIOR MALE			JUNIOR FEMALE		
PLACING	NAME	SCORE	PLACING	NAME	SCORE
1st	Wiz Fineron	534	1st =	Kate Ogilvie	54
2nd	Josiah Jacobson-Grocott	333	1st =	Caroline Webb	54
			3rd	Tess Jacobson-Grocott	47

RECREATIONAL MALE			RECREATIONAL FEMALE		
PLACING	NAME	SCORE	PLACING	NAME	SCORE
1st	Steve Minchin	50	1st =	Lisia Grocott	37
2nd	Ralf Schwoerer	42	1st =	Catherine Moger	28
3rd	Brook Powell	39	3rd	Liz Thevenard	26

A huge thank you to all of the volunteers who made the day possible - Scott Miller, Ivan Vostinar, Rachel Irving, Alice Doughty, Robin Maxwell, and Chris Naylor all did a fantastic job.

And of course the day wouldn't have been the success it was without the generous support of the event's sponsors - Bivouac, Metolious, Tools of the Adventure, Cactus, La Sportiva, and Chalky Digits. Cheers!



Ewan Sinclair on Chris 'n' Cosy (left), while Pete Allison works the neighbouring problem on his way to glory
Images courtesy of Pete McGregor (more photos up soon at <http://www.bhbouldering.blogspot.com/>)



Tomasz Swinarski eying up the next move
Image courtesy of Pete McGregor (more photos up soon at <http://www.bhbouldering.blogspot.com/>)



Images courtesy of Alice Doughty

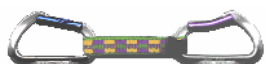


UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Mangaokewa

Date: 26-28 February 2010

Leader: Steve Minchin

Level: Rock grade 18-30

It's not too late to sample the steepness! Mangaokewa offers overhanging sport climbing, with 70 routes mostly in the 18-23 range - this probably isn't a trip for absolute beginners but it should be a good weekend away for those who climb like monkeys... The crag is just out of Te Kuiti and offers free camping, flush toilets, BBQ pits, and a river, so it should be a great place to hang out if the weather is nice. If you are keen to join us please contact Steve at 021 127 3925 or email sm@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Wharepapa South

Date: 12-14 March 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: Rock grade 12-25

Outstanding chance to climb on a wide variety of mid-graded ignimbrite (volcanic rock). An exciting mix of bolted and trad routes 55km south of Hamilton. We'll plan to camp in the area leaving Wellington after work on Friday. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Arrowsmiths from the Lawrence

Date: 1-5 April 2010 (Easter weekend)

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Chance to use some of those lazy last days of the autumn before the first of the snows come in. Walk in will be from Erewhon. The rock is better on western side of the Arrowsmith range. Friday High Camp, Saturday Summit, Sunday Spare Day, Monday Walk Out, Tuesday drive home. There exists the potential for doing a new rock route so bring your cams! Contact Kevin at 027 687 9573 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Whanganui Bay

Date: 23-25 April 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: Rock grade 16-25+

Come join us for a weekend of sport and trad climbing at Whanganui Bay. Plan is to leave Wellington after work on Friday evening and tent for 2 nights at the Bay. With over 1000 routes to choose on classic ignimbrite rock adjacent to the beautiful Lake Taupo from this is truly the Mecca of North Island rock climbing. Try yourself out on the Whakenui classics of Small Pocks (19, sport), James Stirling Direct (17, trad), and the three pitch chimney climb Tibia (16, trad). Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Kawakawa Bay

Date: 7-9 May 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: Rock grade 13-22+

Take a trip to the newly developed crags of nearby Kawakawa Bay. Come along for a weekend of sport (and some trad) climbing on some quality rock, against the backdrop of the largest lake in the North Island. Explore the large number of mid-grade climbs available including the classic 2 pitch High Hopes (16). Hone up on those rock skills with some full pitch climbs. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Mt Tapuae-o-Uenuku

Date: 4-7 June 2010 (Queen's Birthday weekend)

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Opening alpine snow trip for the winter season! Come climb the second highest peak in NZ outside the Mt Cook area. This was one of Hillary's early climbs back in the 1940's, except instead of doing it in 1 day like Sir Ed did we'll take 3! On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up the Hodder River to stay at the Hodder Huts – some 66 crossings! On Sunday we'll attempt a summit via the traditional north ridge. No ropes required. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 or by email at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Ruapehu South

Date: 9-11 July 2010

Leader: TBA

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Ohakune and either tent near the mountain road or stay at the backpackers. Saturday we will ascend the highest point on Ruapehu = Tahurangi peak (2797m) returning for a pub meal at the Powderhorn in the evening. On Sunday we will attempt Girdlestone (2658m), the outlying peak on the right of Tahurangi by crossing the Mangaehuehu Glacier. Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz.



CLASSIFIEDS



DMM ice axes for sale

The DMM Fly has become infamous for its balance and precision. The head is neat and light, with the steel pick running through the headset to reinforce it. The shaft is bent enough for good clearance, but not so much as to make it less user friendly in alpine / mixed situations. The hammer and adze are well featured for mixed climbing too. 50cm. The axes are in good condition. Contact Iain Lea (Christchurch) at iain.lea1@googlemail.com



Winter climbing gear for sale

Black Diamond Sabre Tooth Crampons

Have been used a fair bit but still plenty of life in them. A great general mountaineering crampon that will also climb ice. Standard size (not large) **\$125**

Grivel Rambo Ice climbing Crampons

Had lots of use but still plenty of life in these. Great for someone getting into ice climbing. Standard size (not large) **\$50**.

Mountain Hardwear Womens Conduit Soft Shell Jacket (brand new)

Sky Blue and Chocolate Brown (looks great); Fleece lined (inc collar); Pit Zips; Zip-off hood and zip-off waist powder cuff thing; Internal pockets; Two outside pockets; Womens medium. This is a beautiful jacket, perfect for skiing or winter climbing. Would look good around town too, or a great travel jacket to a winter country. It's brand new - I've had it for a year but never had the use for it. **\$300.00**

Womans Phantom 0deg Sleeping bag

Light four-season bag. This snug mummy cut bag is insulated with 800-fill down, built from Superlight 15 denier fabric and tuck-stitched for durability. Extra insulation in the torso and footbox accommodates a woman's thermal needs in colder conditions. Had little use, a great bag, very compact and warm. See <http://www.mountainhardwear.com> Suits someone no taller than 168cm. Sells for US\$475 in the USA. Selling for **NZ\$400**.

Email Pat pdeavoll@hotmail.com or 021 216 1386.



NOTICES



Climbing in Ecuador

Hello All

We are climbing in the Ecuador this April for a month. There is an open invitation for up to four other climbers to come and join our climbs. This is on a shared cost basis.

Annie and I live in Ecuador (abeit on the beach!) and are planning to spend a month climbing from about 18 April. We are looking at renting an apartment and being based out of Quito. Climbs in Ecuador range from non technical to technical. Objectives would be an acclimatization trek (Quil followed by say four peaks from the following (depending on conditions, and abilities)

El Altar (5319 - technically difficult and remote), Ilinizas (Norte (5126) and Sur (5248)- both reasonably easy, Cayambe (5790) a little technical, Cotopaxi (5897), and Chimborazo (6310). Sangay (5230) - remote - may also be on the list if not active.

Quito is a nice base - as its at 2800m, has all the delights of a Andean city to recover from days of climbing and camping, and also has access via teleferico to trails up to 4600m (so great for acclimatization)

We speak some Spanish - after three years I should speak more! - which should help our small group for organization logistics.

Some climbing experience is needed - but you don't need to be a gun climber! Just friendly, and understanding that not everything works to Swiss (or NZ) precision in Latin America!

My email is warwickwhite@yahoo.co.nz

All the best to all

Warwick (Waz) and Annie



European Reciprocal Hut Fee Tickets – 25 only

Special thanks to John Nankervis who has managed to negotiate for NZAC club members only, to be able to purchase an annual hut ticket to use in the following European Clubs' huts: Huts managed by the Swiss, Austrian, French, Italian and German Alpine Clubs and the Spanish Mountaineering Federation.

The cost to NZAC members is \$100 per ticket. The ticket (sticker) should be attached to the reverse of your NZAC membership card – keeping the UIAA logo visible. They are valid for the calendar year – 2010. The Club has purchased 25 tickets only, but we have so far only been sent 10, so stock is limited. Just drop me an email (margaret@alpineclub.org.nz) if you are interested.



National Boulder Series – NBS – t-shirts for sale

Men's and Women's NBS t-shirts are now for sale online. Made in New Zealand by Chalky Digits most t-shirts are being sent along to the competitions, but we have kept a **very limited** number of stock back at the National Office for purchase via the online system. They come in red only and are available in three sizes each for both men's and women's styles. Prices - \$35 members, \$45 non members, plus p&p. Link to online t-shirt sales here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product?filter0=30>



Damaged Books for sale – limited stock

We are selling copies of the Ebenezer Teichelmann biography, by Bob McKerrow that have minor damage on the corners of the hardcover. The damage is very minimal, but is to your advantage as it means we are selling them at half price, \$20 per copy, plus the standard p&p charge. We will also stamp the inside of the cover with 'cancelled' to differentiate them from the undamaged copies we have for sale. Purchases can be made here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/ebenezer-teichelmann-special>

Special discounted price – limited stock

As well as the above, we are discounting the price of undamaged copies of the Ebenezer Teichelmann book – down from \$40 to \$30 each, plus p&p. Purchases can be made here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/ebenezer-teichelmann>

Any enquiries please contact Margaret McMahon, National Administrator New Zealand Alpine Club Inc margaret@alpineclub.org.nz



Bill Denz - his biography

Wellington section member Paul Maxim is currently writing the biography of this remarkable New Zealand mountaineer. The project is being done with the full endorsement and assistance of Bill's family and friends as well as the NZAC.

Paul would like to hear from anyone he has not already contacted, who climbed with, befriended or was in any way associated with Bill. Paul would particularly like to contact Chris Fraser, who was Bill's climbing partner during his first Mt Cook season (1970/71). If anybody can help with Chris's whereabouts please contact Paul.

If you can help please contact Paul on 04 3896945 (hm) email p.maxim@xtra.co.nz mail: PO Box 7109 Wellington South Wellington 6242.



DVD and Video Lending from the NZAC National Office

We are trialing a new lending system for a growing collection of DVDs (and a few old videos) we have in our collection. Items may be lent for a refundable bond of \$10 each and for an extra non-refundable \$10 we can courier items to you and include a return courier package.

The list is quite small at the moment, but we hope to purchase more DVDs as funds are raised from Movie Nights held in the National Office from time to time.

For a complete list please see this website page, under the Activities header: https://alpineclub.org.nz/activities/DVD_Video_lending

Contact Margaret at the National Office (margaret@alpineclub.org.nz) for lending enquiries.



Mt Olympus 2010 Ski Season

To follow in the snowy footsteps of last year's exceptional team, we are looking for staff with outstanding personalities:

- Snow Safety Manager with AVO 2 +
- Chef for meal planning co-ordination of prep and hut duties
- Admin/Canteen Manager with computer and retail skills, general hut duties
- Ski Instructor and entertainment officer
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Applications to jobs@mtolympus.co.nz



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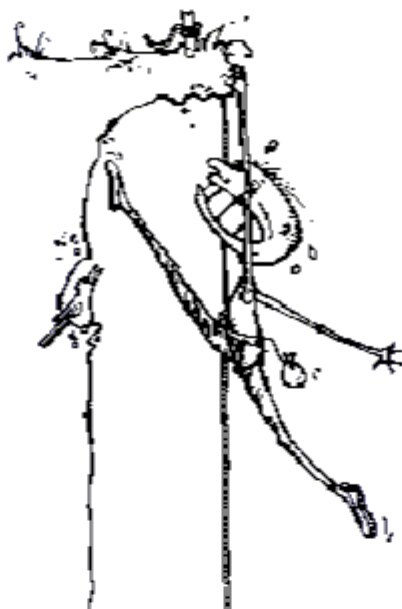


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WELLINGTON SECTION: 2009/10 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	Vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Vacant	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Acting Treasurer	Richard Davies	Treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Kevin Patterson	Trips or KP	04 934 0975 (h) 027 687 9573
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Scott Taylor	ST	
	ShiChang Hou	SH	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Gwen Rashbrooke		
	Hinrich Schaefer		
	Rebecca Thomson		
	Jesse Bailey		
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Kevin Patterson	PLB or KP	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

